Some years later, I returned to Dehradun. After first visiting the old house – it hadn't changed much – I walked out of town towards the river-bed. It was February. As I looked across the dry water-course, my eye was immediately caught by the **spectacular** red blooms of the coral blossom. In contrast with the dry river-bed, the island was a small green paradise. When I went up to the trees, I noticed that some squirrels were living in them and a koel, a crow pheasant, challenged me with a mellow 'who-are-you, who-are-you.'

But the trees seemed to know me; they whispered among themselves and **beckoned** me nearer. And looking around I noticed that other smaller trees, wild plants and grasses had sprung up under their protection. Yes, the trees we had planted long ago had multiplied. They were walking again. In one small corner of the world, Grandfather's dream had come true.

Ruskin Bond

Ruskin Bond is an award winning Indian author of more than 500 books, short stories, essays and novels. He writes poetry and books for children as well as adults. He lives with his adopted family in Landour, in Mussoorie, India. He was awarded the Padma Shri in 1999 and Padma Bhushan in 2014.

Discuss and answer.

1. What did Grandmother feel about trees growing in the house?
2. Why did the author leave town?
3. How did Grandfather's dream come true?
4. Describe what the author saw when he went back to the island.

AYPHC

GLOSSARY

rambling	-	wandering
sprout	-	when seeds begin to grow into small plants
spectacular	-	eye-catching
beckoned	-	to signal (someone) with your hand to ask the person to come closer or follow

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